

Launch manual

Everything left to do, in the order to do it. Written for someone who is not a developer. Storage stays on Supabase throughout — no Cloudflare account is needed, now or later.

8

STEPS TO LIVE

None of them need code. Two are copy-and-paste, four are typing your own details, and two are clicking through a dashboard. Budget an afternoon.

Print this and tick the boxes as you go.

01 The whole launch, on one page

Do these in order. Steps 1 and 2 must happen before anything else works; the rest can be done in any order but all of them must be done before you show this to a client.

☐ 01 Run the database script

Supabase → SQL Editor · 2 min

Creates the reader list and the new per-device banner columns. Until this is done, the email sign-up box on the site returns an error. Full instructions in section 02.

☐ 02 Check the storage bucket

Supabase → Storage · 2 min

A public bucket named `media` holding your PDFs and artwork. It already exists and has been given a 50 MB ceiling and a file-type allow-list. Section 03 tells you how to confirm.

☐ 03 Replace the placeholder contact details

site.config.ts · 10 min

The phone number on the site is a reserved 555 number that can never connect, and the email and address are invented. This is the one thing that would embarrass a live site. Section 04.

☐ 04 Put your real logo in

public/brand/ · 10 min

The bird mark on the site was redrawn from the image you sent, because the file itself could not be recovered from the chat. Section 05.

☐ 05 Invite yourself as an administrator

Supabase → Authentication · 3 min

Sign-ups are disabled on purpose, so the only way in is an invitation you send from the Supabase dashboard. Section 06.

☐ 06 Deploy and point the domain

Your host · 45 min

Push the code to a host, paste the environment variables in, and point vaaram.ca at it. Section 07.

☐ 07 Publish the first real edition

Admin → Publish · 10 min

The eighteen demo editions vanish by themselves the moment one real issue exists. Nothing needs deleting. Section 08.

☐ 08 Walk the launch checklist

Your live site · 5 min

Ten checks that take five minutes and catch everything that commonly goes wrong on the first day. Section 11.

What is already done

The database tables, the security rules, the storage bucket and its limits, all ten advertising slots, the responsive banner system, the security headers and the whole front end are built and tested. The list above is only the part that needs your accounts and your details — none of it needs a developer.

02

Step 1 – Run the database script

Two minutes, and nothing else works until it is done.

Open your Supabase project, click **SQL Editor** in the left sidebar, then **New query**. Open the file `supabase/schema.sql` from the project, copy **all** of it, paste it into the editor and press **Run**.

It is written to be safe to run as many times as you like — running it twice changes nothing. You should see `Success`. `No rows returned` when it finishes.

What it creates

TABLE	WHAT IT HOLDS
publications	One row per weekly edition — title, date, the PDF, page count, view and download counts.
ad_banners	Every booked advertisement, including the new per-device artwork columns.
enquiries	Messages from the contact form.
subscribers	Readers who asked to be emailed when an edition goes live. This is the new one.

How to know it worked

Sign in to the site's own admin at `/admin/settings`. If any table is still missing it is named there in an amber warning. No warning means the database is correct. You can also try the email sign-up box on the home page — it will save silently instead of returning an error.

If you would rather paste just the new part

Running the whole file is safer and is what we recommend. But if you have already run an older version of the script and only want what changed, this is it:

```
-- Per-device banner artwork (optional; falls back to desktop)
alter table public.ad_banners add column if not exists image_url_tablet text;
alter table public.ad_banners add column if not exists image_key_tablet text;
alter table public.ad_banners add column if not exists image_url_mobile text;
alter table public.ad_banners add column if not exists image_key_mobile text;

-- The reader email list
create table if not exists public.subscribers (
  id          uuid primary key default gen_random_uuid(),
  created_at  timestampz not null default now(),
  email       varchar(190) not null unique,
  source      varchar(40)  not null default 'home',
  is_active   boolean      not null default true,
  unsubscribed_at timestampz
);
alter table public.subscribers enable row level security;
create policy "admins manage subscribers" on public.subscribers
  for all to authenticated using (true) with check (true);
```

03

Step 2 – Storage, on Supabase

Your PDFs and every piece of banner artwork live in a Supabase bucket. It is already set up. This section is how to check it, and what its limits mean for you.

In Supabase, click **Storage**. You should see one bucket named `media` marked **Public**. Public is correct and necessary: a reader's browser has to be able to fetch an edition PDF and a banner image without signing in. Nothing private is ever put in it — enquiries and subscriber addresses live in the database, which is not public.

The limits already applied

SETTING	VALUE	WHY
File size ceiling	50 MB	The maximum your Supabase plan allows. The site refuses anything larger before the upload starts, so you never watch a long upload fail.
Allowed types	PDF, JPG, PNG, WebP, SVG	Storage refuses anything else even if something tried to send it.
Banner artwork cap	2 MB	Enforced by the site. Artwork is served exactly as uploaded, so one oversized image would become every visitor's download.

The one number to watch

The free Supabase plan includes roughly 5 GB of downloads a month. A 10 MB edition read 500 times is 5 GB. If the magazine gets popular you will see this in the Supabase usage page before anything breaks — and the fix is a paid plan or moving files to Cloudflare R2, which the site already supports by filling in five environment variables. Nothing needs re-uploading when you switch: new files go to the new home and every existing link keeps working.

Keeping editions small

- Export the PDF at **150 dpi** rather than 300 for the web copy. A 40-page edition should land between 3 MB and 10 MB.
- In Acrobat: **File** → **Save As Other** → **Reduced Size PDF**. In Preview on a Mac: **File** → **Export** → **Quartz Filter** → **Reduce File Size**.
- Keep the print-ready original elsewhere. What you upload here is the reading copy.

04 Step 3 – Your real details

Everything a visitor reads that is not an edition comes from a single file. Open `site.config.ts` in the project root and work down it.

LINE	CURRENTLY	CHANGE IT TO
<code>contact.email</code>	<code>hello@vaaram.ca</code>	The inbox you actually read.
<code>contact.phone</code>	<code>+1 647 555 0199</code>	Your real number. 555 numbers are reserved and can never connect — this is the most important one.
<code>contact.whatsapp</code>	<code>16475550199</code>	Digits only, with country code, no plus sign. Leave empty to hide WhatsApp everywhere.
<code>contact.address</code>	<code>Toronto, Ontario, Canada</code>	Your street address, or the city if you would rather not publish one.
<code>contact.hours</code>	<code>Mon – Sat, 9–6 ET</code>	When someone can expect an answer.
<code>social.*</code>	<code>empty</code>	Facebook, Instagram and YouTube addresses. Anything left empty simply does not appear.

Also worth a read while you are in there

- **ticker** — the scrolling lines at the very top of every page.
- **categories** — the six sections shown as what is inside an edition. Change these if your magazine carries different ones; they appear on the home page and the About page.
- **faq** — the six questions on the Contact page. These are also published as structured data, so a search engine may quote them word for word. Keep every answer true.
- **publishDay** and **publishDayLabel** — currently Sunday. Change both together if you publish on a different day.

Anything marked PLACEHOLDER

Search the file for the word `PLACEHOLDER`. Every one of them is a deliberately fake value that must be replaced before launch. When the search returns nothing, this step is done.

05

Step 4 – Your real logo

The bird mark on the site today is a vector redrawn from the image you sent, because the image itself could not be pulled out of the chat as a file. Same maroon, same rose gold, same bird — but not your artwork.

Ask your designer for the mark as an **SVG**, without the wordmark and without the web address beside it — just the bird, trimmed tight, on a transparent background. Then:

- Save it over `public/brand/vaaram-mark.svg`.
- Open `components/site/VaaramMark.tsx` and replace the drawing inside the `<svg>` with the contents of your file, keeping the surrounding component exactly as it is.
- If your designer can only supply a PNG, that works for the favicon but not for the header — ask for the SVG, it is the same file they used to make the PNG.

Why two files

One is the flat artwork used for the browser-tab icon and the picture that appears when someone shares a link. The other is the version used in the header, footer and admin, which recolours itself for light mode, dark mode and the deep wine bands. Replacing both keeps them identical.

The rest of the identity is already set

The site's colours were taken from your logotype: the maroon of the wordmark is the accent throughout, and the rose gold of the mark's feathers carries the small labels. The headline typeface matches the one you asked for. None of that changes when you swap the mark.

06

Step 5 – Getting into the admin

There is no password and no sign-up form. You invite yourself once from Supabase, and after that you sign in with a six-digit code emailed to you.

Invite yourself

- Supabase → **Authentication** → **Users** → **Add user** → **Send invitation**.
- Enter the email address you want to publish from. You will get an invitation email — accept it.
- Supabase → **Authentication** → **Providers** → **Email**: make sure **Enable sign-ups** is **off**. This is what stops anyone else requesting a code.

Signing in from then on

Go to `/admin`, type your address, and a six-digit code arrives by email. It is valid for a few minutes and can only be used once. There is no password to forget, lose or leak.

Adding a second person later

Repeat the invitation step with their address. Everyone invited has the same full access — there are no separate roles — so only invite people you would trust to delete an edition.

What the admin can do

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Dashboard	Live counts of editions, views, waiting enquiries, running banners and readers on the list.
Publish	Upload the week's PDF. The cover picture and page count are worked out for you.
Issues	Every edition. Hide one, show it again, or delete it.
Enquiries	Everything sent through the contact form. Mark each one contacted or closed.
Banners	Book, schedule and retire advertisements. Views and click rate per banner.
Readers	The email list. Export it, or unsubscribe someone by hand.
Settings	What is connected, what is missing, and a warning if the database is out of date.

07 Step 6 – Going live

Any host that runs Next.js will do. Vercel is the least work and has a free tier that fits this site.

- Push the project to a GitHub repository.
- At your host, create a new project from that repository. Next.js is detected automatically — accept the defaults.
- Before the first deploy, paste in the environment variables from the table below.
- Deploy. When it succeeds, add your domain in the host's settings and follow its instructions for pointing `vaaram.ca` at it.
- Set `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL` to the final address and deploy once more — the sitemap, the share card and every canonical link read that value.

Environment variables

VARIABLE	NEEDED	WHERE IT COMES FROM
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL</code>	Yes	Your live address, no trailing slash. https://www.vaaram.ca
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_URL</code>	Yes	Supabase → Project Settings → Data API
<code>NEXT_PUBLIC_SUPABASE_ANON_KEY</code>	Yes*	The public key. *Or the PUBLISHABLE one — whichever pair your dashboard shows.
<code>SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY</code>	Yes*	The secret key. Never prefix with <code>NEXT_PUBLIC_</code> . *Or <code>SUPABASE_SECRET_KEY</code> .
<code>WEB3FORMS_ACCESS_KEY</code>	No	Emails you a copy of each enquiry. Enquiries save either way.
<code>R2_*</code> and <code>NEXT_PUBLIC_R2_PUBLIC_URL</code>	No	Leave every one blank. That is what keeps storage on Supabase.

Keep the R2 lines empty

The five Cloudflare R2 variables are what switch storage away from Supabase. Leaving them blank is a supported, tested configuration and is what this manual assumes throughout. Fill them in only when download volume makes it worthwhile.

The secret key really is secret

`SUPABASE_SERVICE_ROLE_KEY` bypasses every permission rule in the database. It must only ever be set on the server, never prefixed with `NEXT_PUBLIC_`, and never committed to the repository. If it is ever exposed, rotate it in Supabase immediately — Project Settings → API → Reset.

08 Step 7 – Publishing an edition

The weekly job, and the one you will do most often. It takes about a minute once the PDF is ready.

- Admin → **Publish**.
- Drag the week's PDF onto the upload area. The page count and the cover picture are read out of the file automatically.
- Give it a title — `Issue 205` or `Week of 14 September`, whichever you prefer, but stay consistent.
- Set the edition date. This is what the archive sorts and groups by, so it matters more than the title.
- Write a sentence or two describing what is in this week's issue. It appears on the edition card and in search results.
- **Publish now** puts it live immediately. **Save as draft** keeps it hidden until you are ready.

The demo editions

Until you publish a real edition the site shows eighteen generated examples so nothing looks empty. They disappear on their own the moment one real issue exists — there is nothing to delete and no setting to change.

Where a published edition appears

Immediately, and everywhere: the home page hero, the edition record below it, the archive in all three views, the sitemap search engines read, and its own page with the reader. This was verified end to end — a row written to the database appeared on the home page and the archive on the next request, with no cache to clear by hand.

09 Advertising banners, and the new per-device artwork

Ten sellable positions across the site. Each one can now carry different artwork for phones, tablets and desktops — because a wide desktop strip is unreadable when squeezed onto a phone.

How it works

When you add a banner you choose the placement first, and the form then shows you three upload boxes with the exact pixel size each one wants. **Desktop is required.** Tablet and phone are optional — anything you leave empty quietly falls back to the desktop artwork, so a single image still works everywhere.

A visitor's browser then downloads only the artwork for its own screen. A phone never pays for the desktop file.

What to ask an advertiser for

PLACEMENT	KEY	DESKTOP	TABLET	PHONE
Home — under the hero	home_hero	1600 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400
Home — mid page	home_mid	1200 × 250	1200 × 300	800 × 500
Home — feature block	home_feature	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400
Home — above closing call	home_closing	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400
Archive — above editions	listing_top	1600 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400
Archive — between editions	listing_inline	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400
Reader — above the pages	reader_top	1600 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400
Reader — beside the pages	reader_sidebar	600 × 500	1000 × 600	1000 × 600
Reader — under the pages	reader_below	1200 × 250	1200 × 300	800 × 500
Every page — above footer	footer	1200 × 200	1200 × 250	800 × 400

Adding one

- Admin → **Banners**. Choose **where it appears** first — the sizes below it change to match.
- Upload the desktop artwork. Add tablet and phone artwork too if the advertiser supplied them.
- Enter the advertiser's name — this is only for you, so you can find the banner later.
- Add the link it should open when clicked. Only ordinary web addresses are accepted; anything else is refused.
- Optionally set an end date, and optionally restrict it to one edition.

Artwork must be under 2 MB

Every visitor downloads banner artwork exactly as you upload it. A 4 MB photograph would be a 4 MB download on every page it appears. The form refuses anything larger and tells you the size — export as JPG at around 80% quality, or WebP if your designer can supply it.

Reading the list

Each banner shows three small tags — Desktop, Tablet and Phone. A green tag means the advertiser supplied artwork drawn for that size; a grey one with an arrow means it falls back to the desktop image. Neither is wrong; the tags

simply let you see at a glance which bookings are fully dressed. Underneath, views, clicks and the click rate.

Empty slots are never holes

A placement with nothing booked shows Vaaram's own quiet panel — labelled as Vaaram advertising, styled unlike any paid banner, linking to your contact page. It keeps the layout intact before your first client signs, and sells the slot while it waits.

10 Security – what was done, and what to keep doing

Five issues were found and fixed while preparing this. None had reached the public site, because the site has not been public. They are listed so you know what was checked.

ISSUE	STATUS	WHAT IT WAS
Structured-data injection	Fixed	An edition title containing markup could have broken out of the hidden data block search engines read. Every one of those blocks is now escaped.
Unsafe banner links	Fixed	A banner link is now filtered to ordinary web addresses only, both when saved and again before the page is built, so an older row cannot slip through.
No upload size limit	Fixed	Editions are capped at 50 MB, artwork at 2 MB, and Supabase Storage now enforces both independently of the site.
Open counter endpoint	Fixed	The address that records banner views was rate-limited. Advertisers are shown these numbers, so inflating them was an integrity problem.
Missing security headers	Fixed	A content security policy, strict transport security and a frame ban were added. The site can no longer be embedded in someone else's page.

What was already right

- **The database enforces its own rules.** A visitor can read published editions and running banners and nothing else. Enquiries and subscriber addresses are unreadable to the public no matter what the website asks for.
- **No password to steal.** Admin access is an emailed one-time code with sign-ups disabled.
- **No tracking.** No cookie, no IP address, no visitor identity is stored — which is why the site legitimately needs no cookie banner.
- **Forms are rate-limited** and carry a honeypot, so automated submissions are turned away without a captcha.
- **Uploads never pass through the server** — the browser is handed a short-lived signed link and sends the file straight to storage.

Your ongoing part

- Never share the secret key, and never paste it anywhere with `NEXT_PUBLIC_` in front of it.
- Keep sign-ups disabled in Supabase. Check it after any Supabase update.
- Only invite administrators you would trust to delete an edition.
- If someone leaves, remove their user in Supabase → Authentication → Users.

One known limitation, stated plainly

The content security policy still allows inline scripts, because the framework needs them and removing that safely requires a change to how every page is served. It is a hardening improvement, not an open door — everything else the policy covers is locked down. Worth doing later; not worth delaying launch for.

11 Step 8 – The launch-day checklist

Five minutes on the live site. Every one of these has caught a real problem on a real launch at some point.

- ☐ The home page loads at your real domain, with a padlock in the address bar.
- ☐ The phone number in the footer is yours, and dialling it rings you.
- ☐ The email address in the footer is yours, and a message to it arrives.
- ☐ This week's edition opens in the reader and the pages turn.
- ☐ The download button gives you the PDF.
- ☐ Send yourself an enquiry through the contact form, then find it in Admin → Enquiries.
- ☐ Put your own address into the email sign-up box, then find it in Admin → Readers.
- ☐ Open the site on your phone. Check the hero, the menu, and an edition.
- ☐ Admin → Settings shows no amber warnings.
- ☐ Search for your business name on Google in a week — the sitemap is submitted automatically, but indexing takes days.

12 If something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE

WHAT IT MEANS

WHAT TO DO

The sign-up box says it could not save

The subscribers table does not exist.

Run the database script — section 02.

Amber warning in Admin → Settings

The database is behind the code.

Run the database script again. It is safe to repeat.

An upload fails part way

Usually the file is over the ceiling.

Editions must be under 50 MB, artwork under 2 MB. Export smaller.

A banner does not appear

It is hidden, expired, or set to a different edition.

Check it in Admin → Banners: the tags show hidden and expired.

A new edition is not on the home page

It was saved as a draft.

Admin → Issues, then Show.

Demo editions still showing

No real edition is published yet.

Publish one. They vanish by themselves.

Cannot sign in

The address was never invited, or sign-ups are off and it is not on the list.

Invite it in Supabase → Authentication → Users.

Verified before this manual was written

A real edition was written to the live database and appeared on the home page, the archive and its own reader page. A real banner was booked and rendered in its slot with the correct artwork chosen at desktop, tablet and phone widths. A real enquiry was submitted through the form and arrived in the database. Every admin address was confirmed to bounce a signed-out visitor to the sign-in page. All test data was then removed. The only thing that could not be tested is the reader email list, because its table does not exist until you run step 1.